

## TOPIC 6: PUBLIC SERVICE

### 1. Meaning of Public Service

Public service is work done for the benefit of the public, usually through government or public institutions. Public servants (civil servants, teachers in public schools, health workers, police, etc.) are employed to deliver services that the private sector alone may not provide adequately.

### 2. Importance of Public Service

- Provides essential services: education, health, security, roads, water, electricity regulation.
- Implements government policies and programmes.
- Ensures continuity of administration beyond political changes.
- Protects the weak and maintains order and justice.

### 3. Challenges

- Corruption and misuse of public funds.
- Inefficiency, bureaucracy and delays.
- Inadequate training, equipment or motivation.
- Political interference and lack of merit in appointments.
- Poor public perception and low trust.

### 4. Improving Public Service

Transparency, accountability, training, fair recruitment, adequate pay, and a culture of service can strengthen public service. Citizens also help by reporting problems and demanding good service.

### 5. Summary

Public service delivers essential goods and services for the common good. Despite challenges, a professional and honest public service is vital for development and good governance.

End of Topic 6